

Regression:

A machine learning perspective

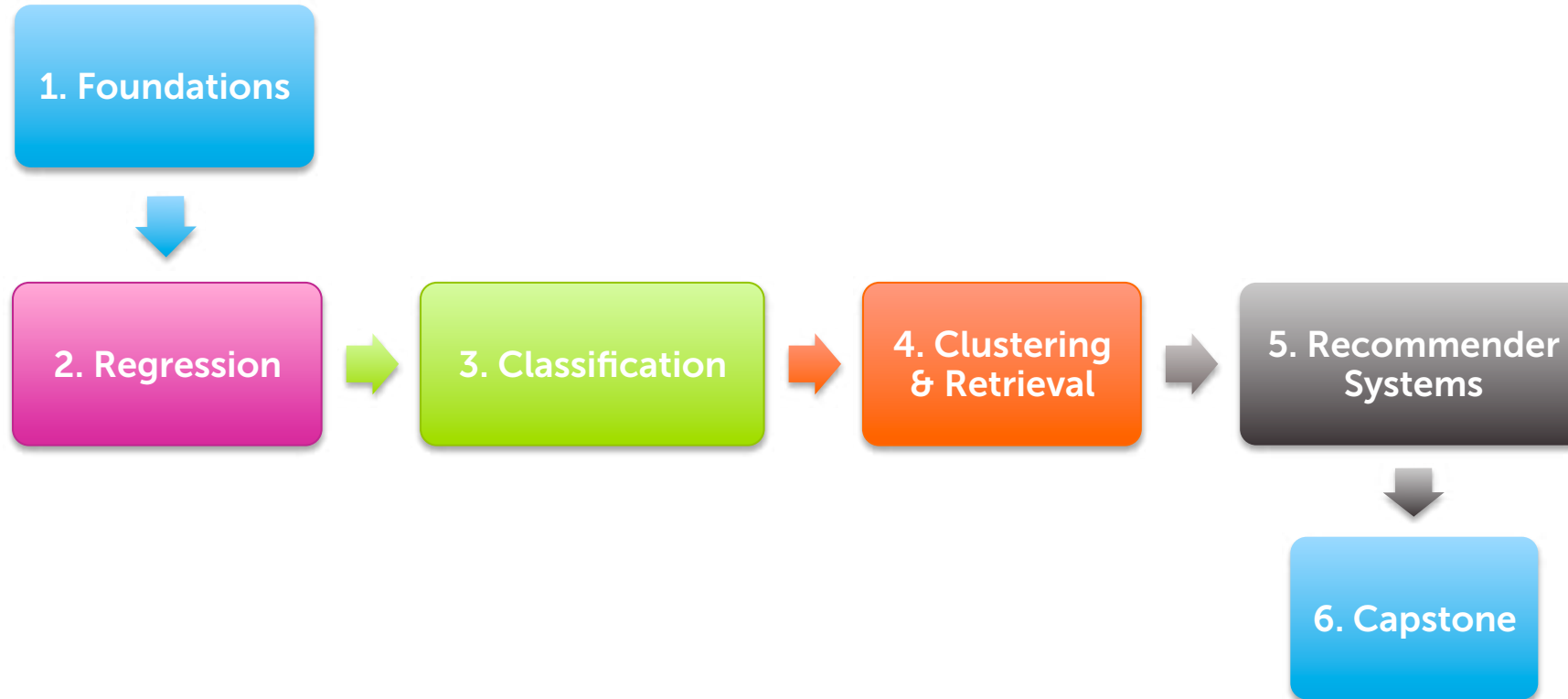
Emily Fox & Carlos Guestrin

Machine Learning Specialization

University of Washington

Part of a specialization

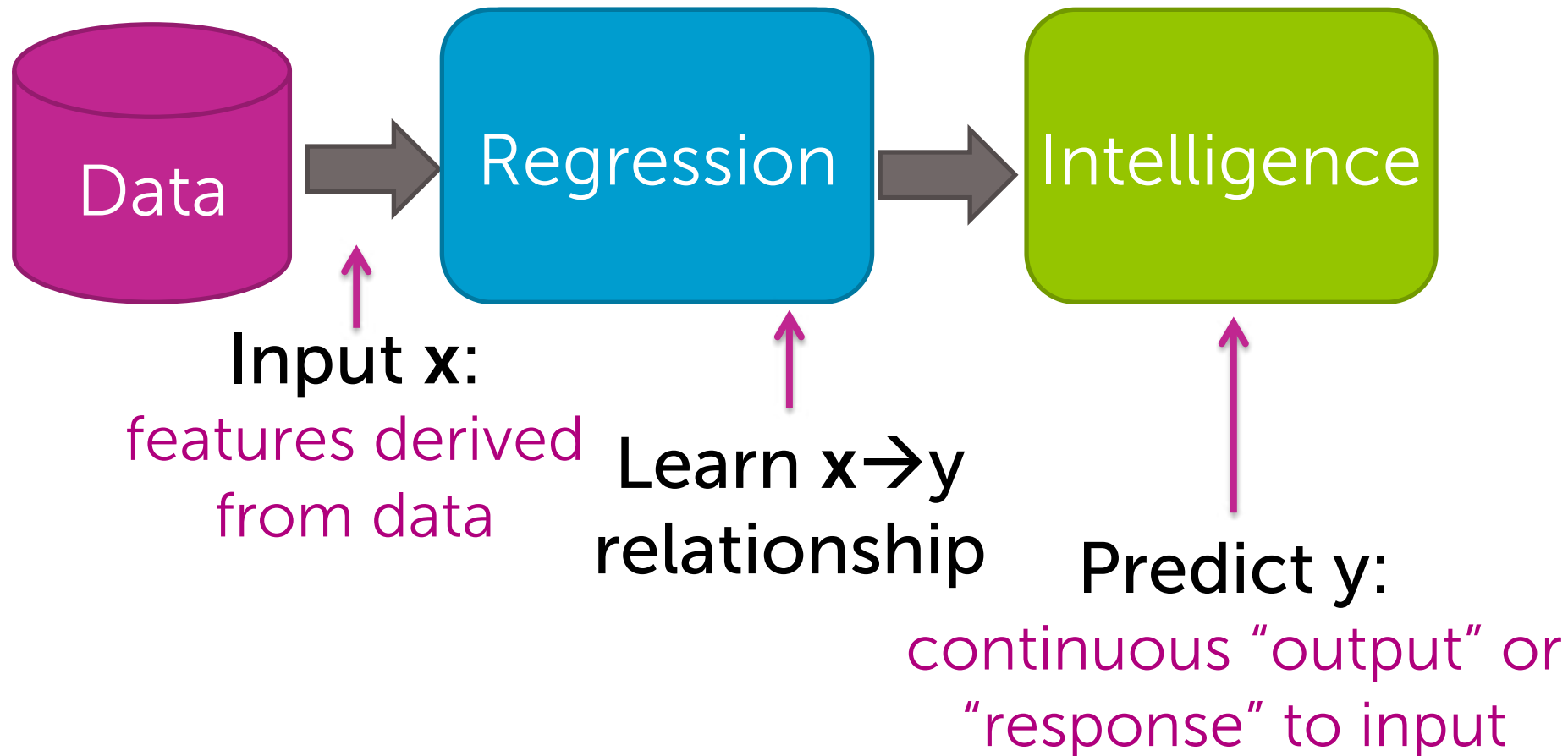
This course is a part of the Machine Learning Specialization



What is the course about?

What is regression?

From features to predictions



Salary after ML specialization



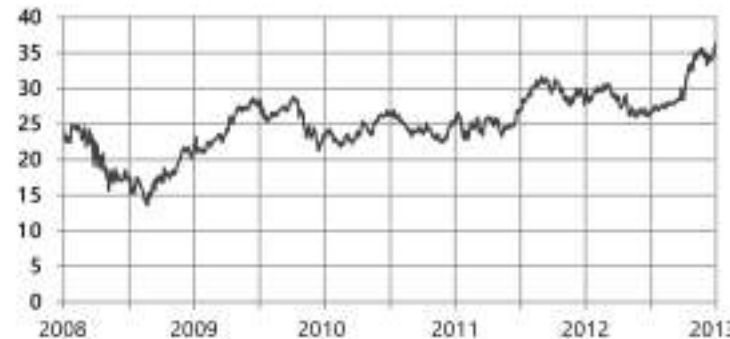
hard work



- How much will your salary be? ($y = \$\$$)
- Depends on $\mathbf{x}$ = performance in courses, quality of capstone project, # of forum responses, ...

Stock prediction

- Predict the price of a stock (y)
- Depends on $\mathbf{x}$ =
 - Recent history of stock price
 - News events
 - Related commodities

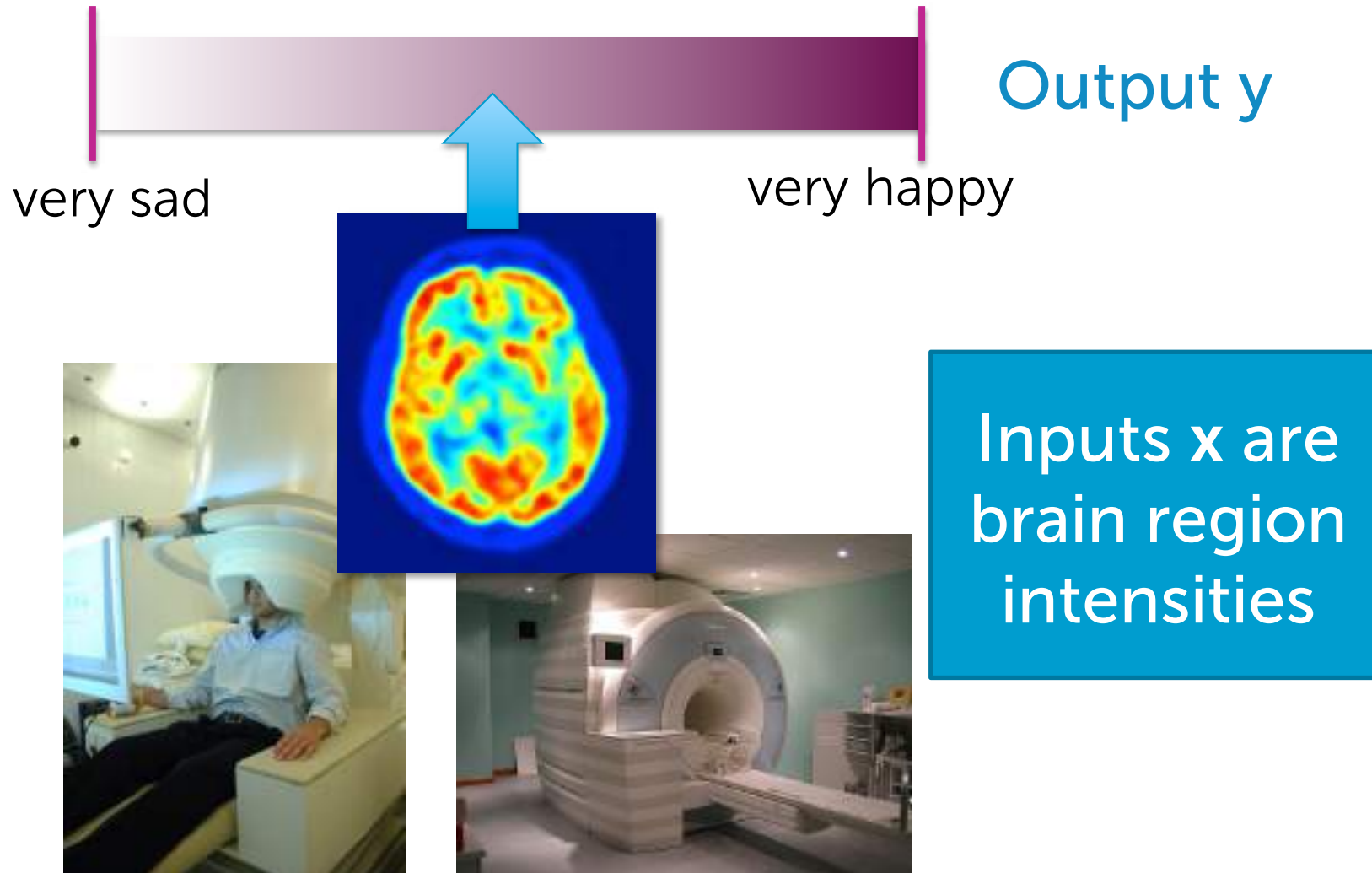


Tweet popularity

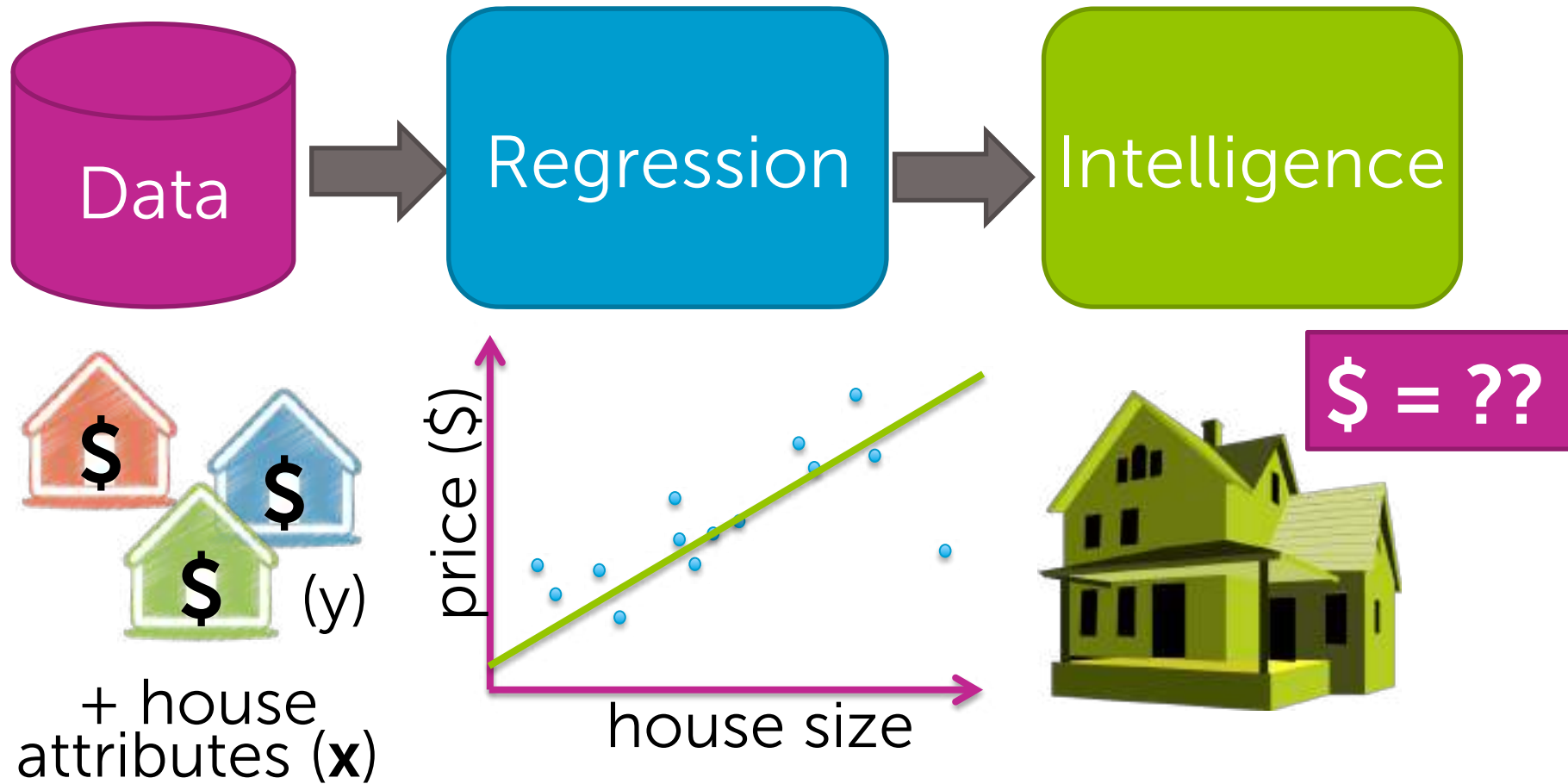
- How many people will retweet your tweet? (y)
- Depends on $\mathbf{x}$ = # followers,
of followers of followers,
features of text tweeted,
popularity of hashtag,
of past retweets,...



Reading your mind



Case Study: Predicting house prices



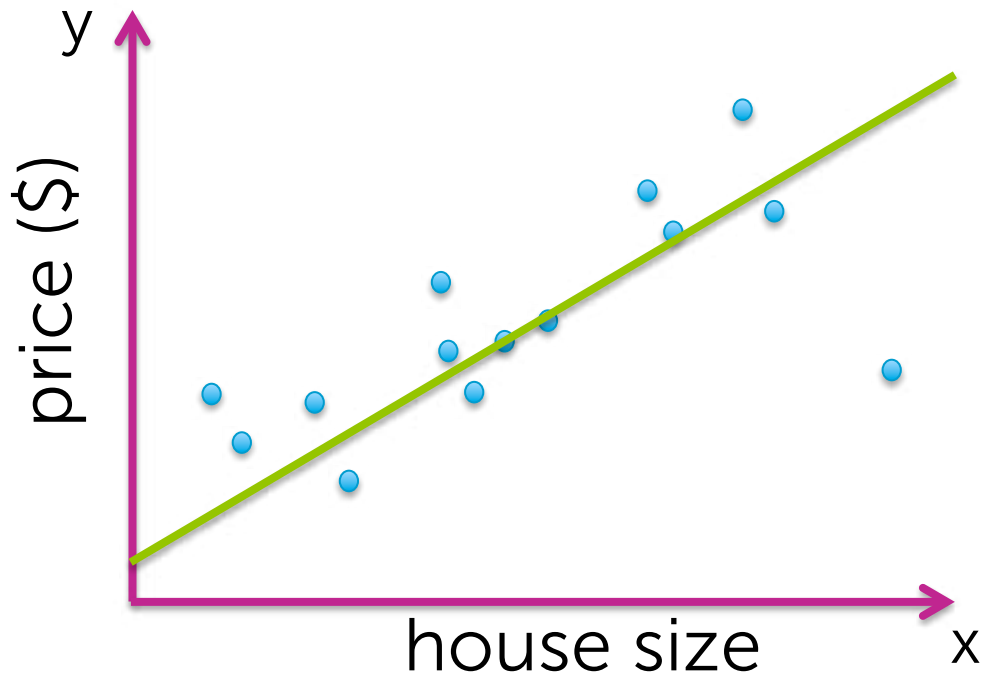
Impact of regression

Course outline

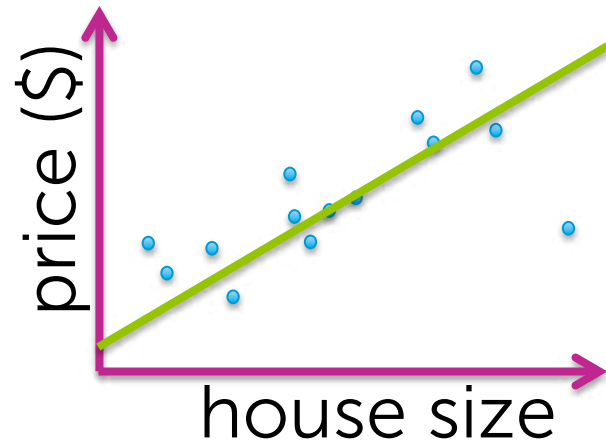
Module 1: Simple Regression

What makes it simple?

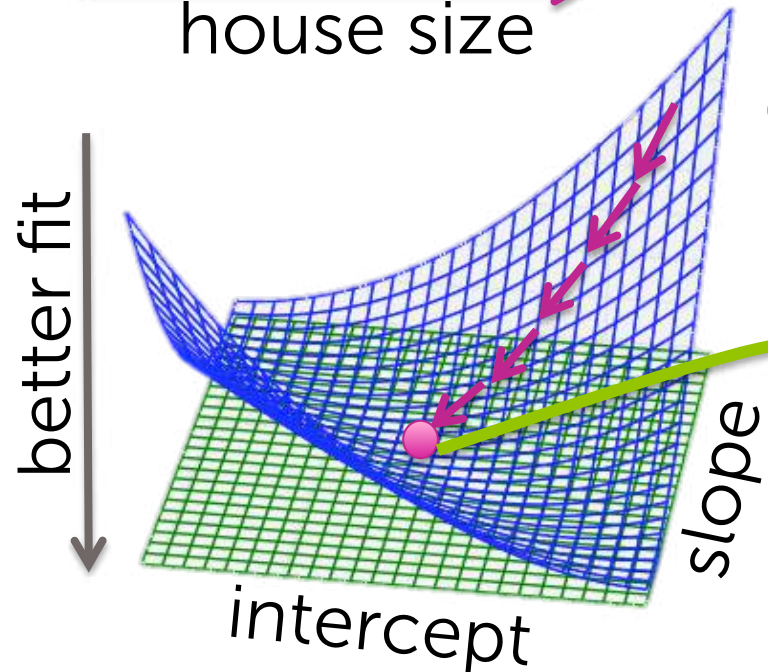
1 input and just fit a line to data



Module 1: Simple Regression



Define **goodness-of-fit** metric for each possible line

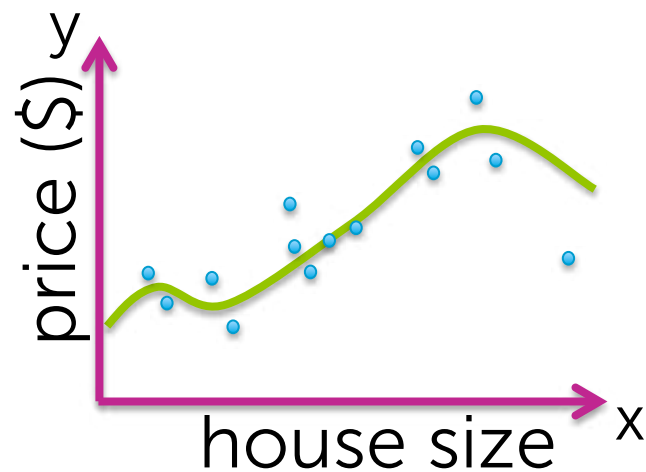


Gradient descent algorithm

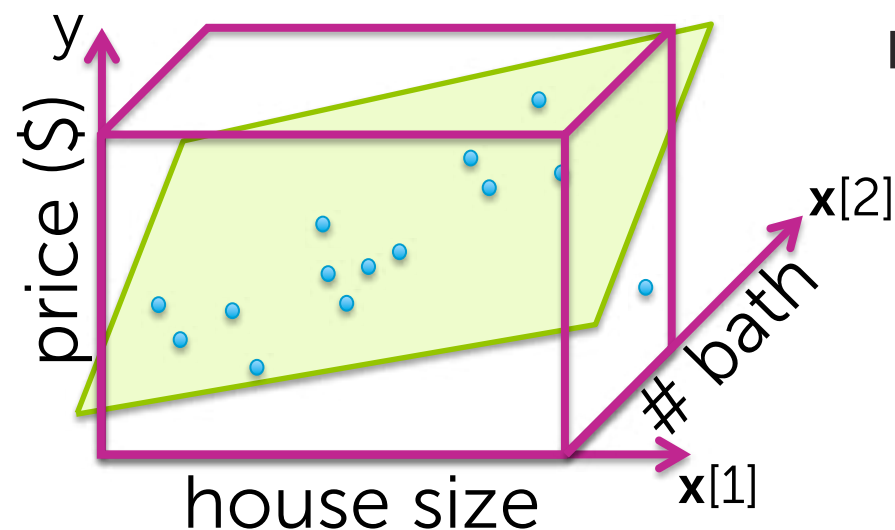
Get estimated parameters

- interpret
- use to form predictions

Module 2: Multiple Regression



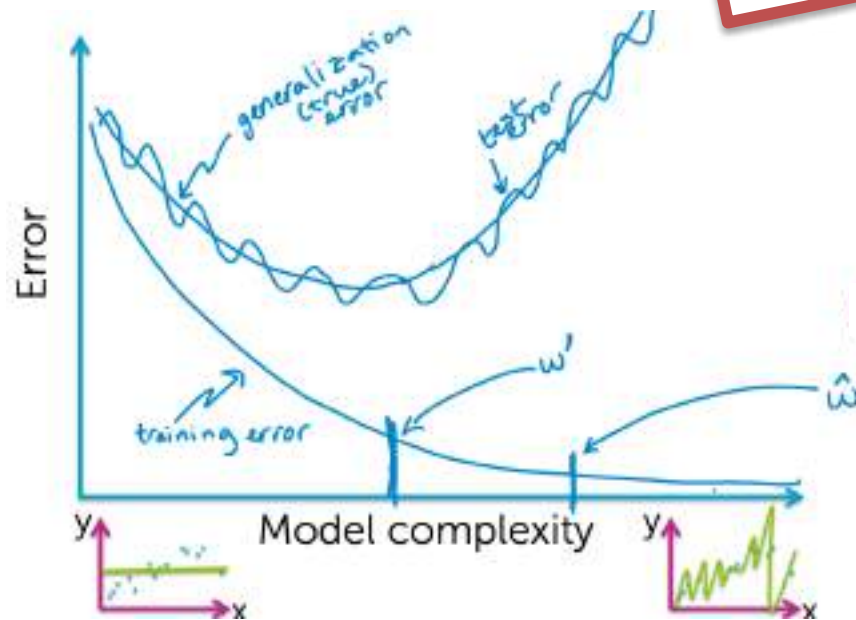
Fit **more complex relationships** than just a line



Incorporate more inputs

- Square feet
- # bathrooms
- # bedrooms
- Lot size
- Year built
- ...

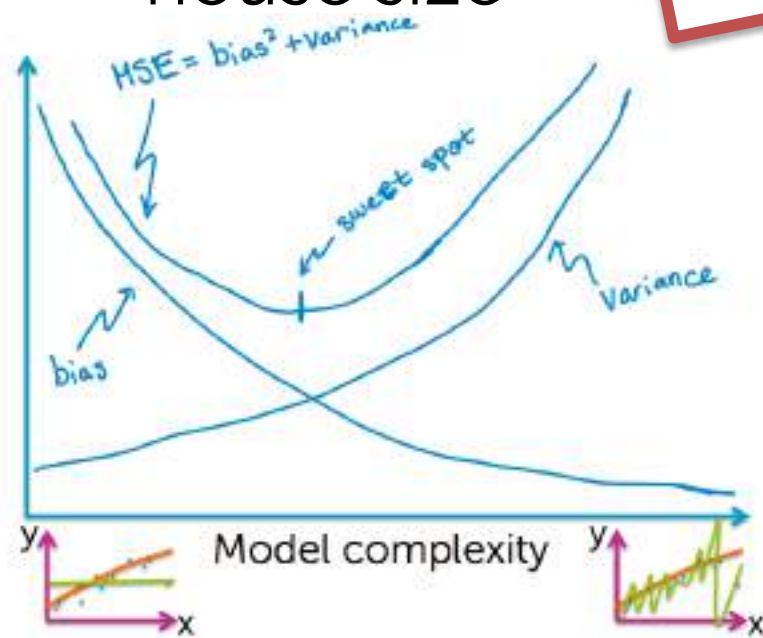
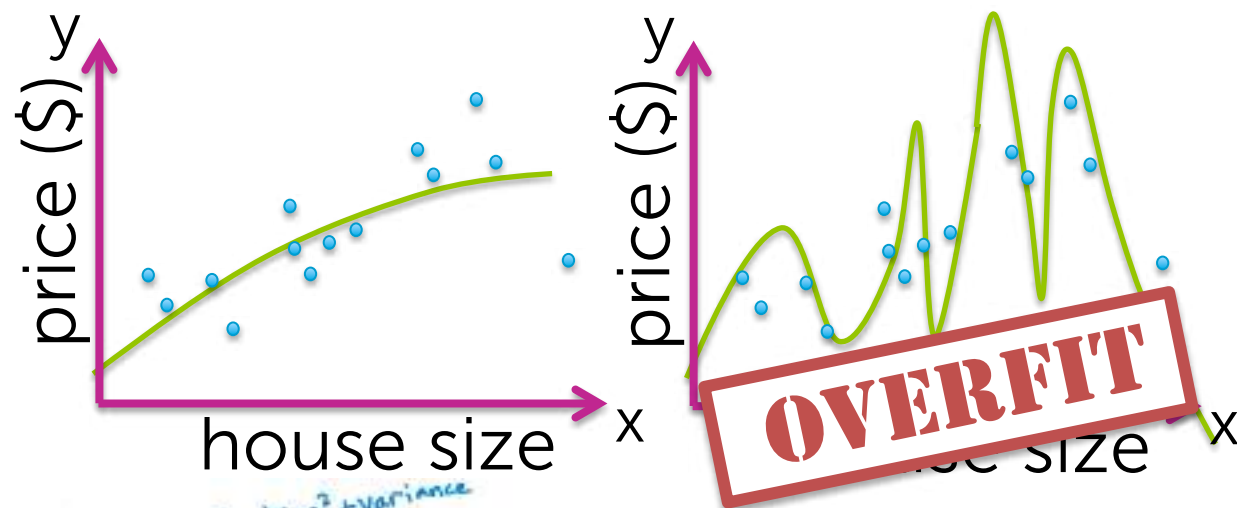
Module 3: Assessing Performance



Measures of error:

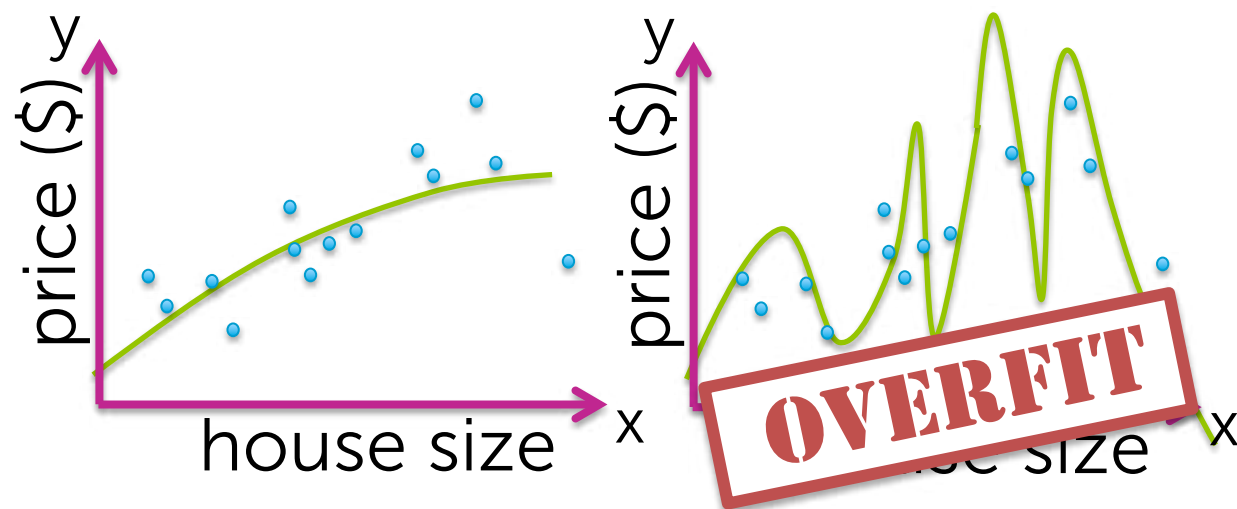
- Training
- Test
- True (generalization)

Module 3: Assessing Performance



Bias-variance
tradeoff

Module 4: Ridge Regression



Ridge total cost =
measure of fit + measure of
model complexity

↗

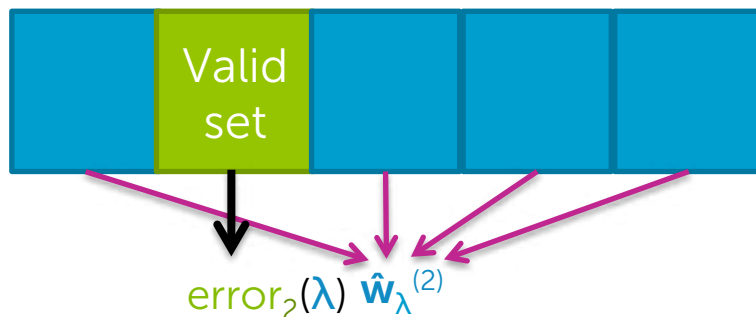
bias-variance tradeoff

Module 4: Ridge Regression

How to choose balance?
(i.e., model complexity)

measure of fit + measure of
model complexity

Cross validation



Module 5: Feature Selection & Lasso Regression



Useful for **efficiency**
of predictions and
interpretability

Lot size
Single Family
Year built
Last sold price
Last sale price/sqft
Finished sqft
Unfinished sqft
Finished basement sqft
floors
Flooring types
Parking type
Parking amount
Cooling
Heating
Exterior materials
Roof type
Structure style

Dishwasher
Garbage disposal
Microwave
Range / Oven
Refrigerator
Washer
Dryer
Laundry location
Heating type
Jetted Tub
Deck
Fenced Yard
Lawn
Garden
Sprinkler System
⋮

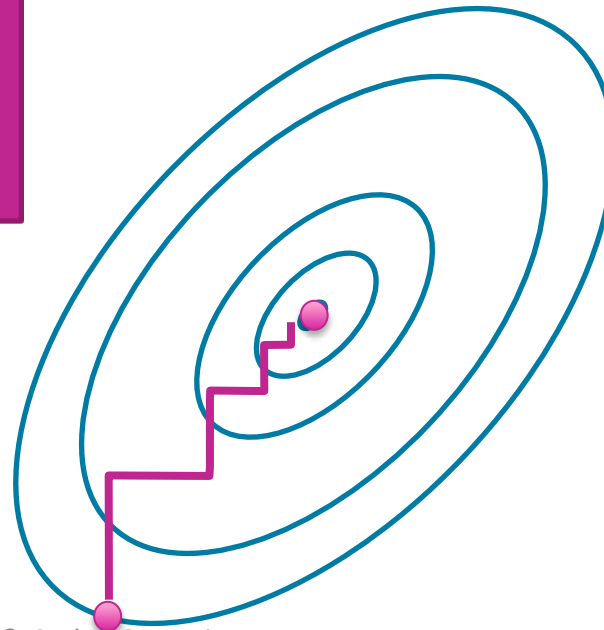
Module 5: Feature Selection & Lasso Regression

Lasso total cost =

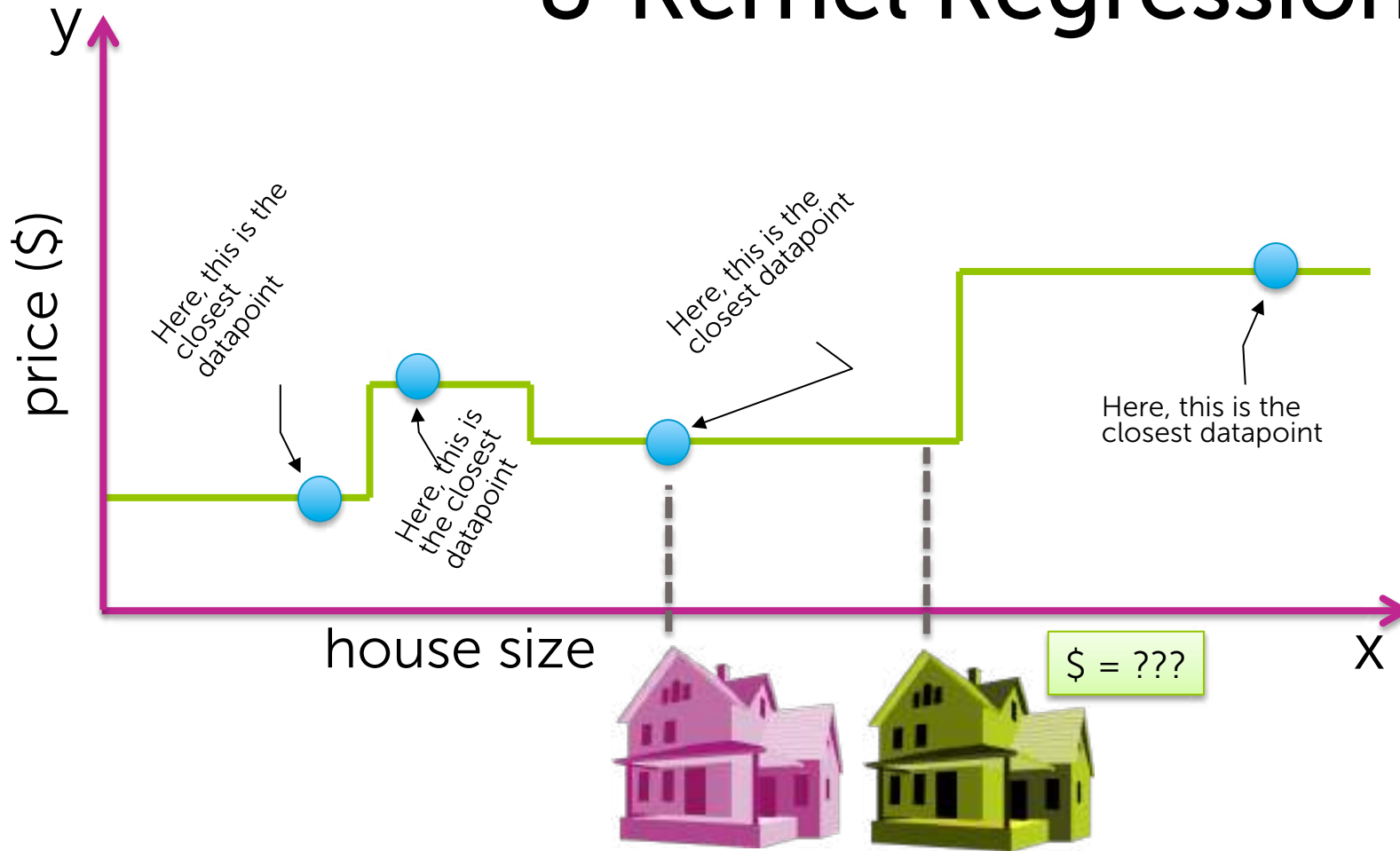
measure of fit + (different) measure of
model complexity

knocks out certain features...
"sparsity"

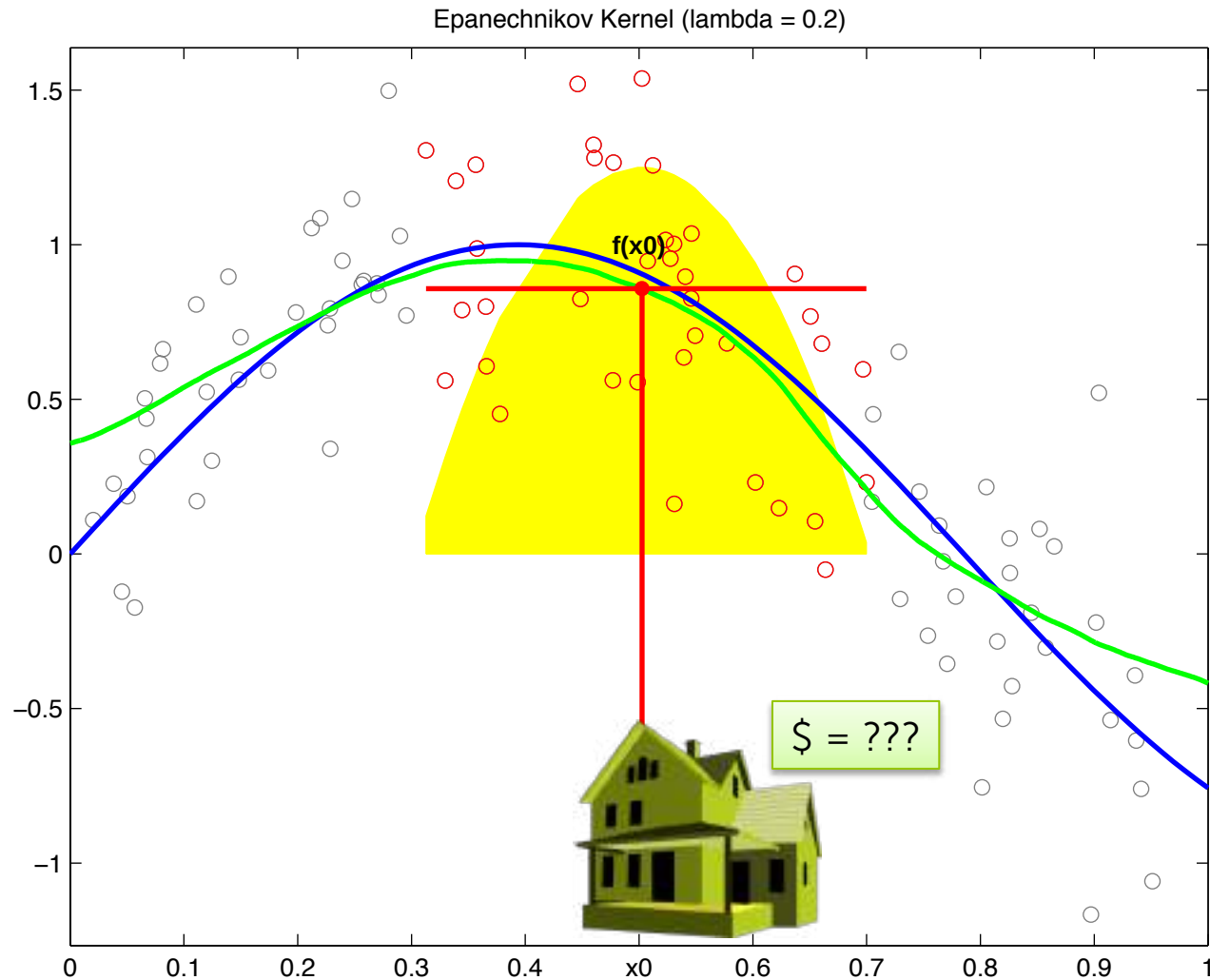
Coordinate descent algorithm



Module 6: Nearest Neighbor & Kernel Regression



Module 6: Nearest Neighbor & Kernel Regression



Summary of what's covered

Models

- Linear regression
- Regularization: Ridge (L2), Lasso (L1)
- Nearest neighbor and kernel regression

Algorithms

- Gradient descent
- Coordinate descent

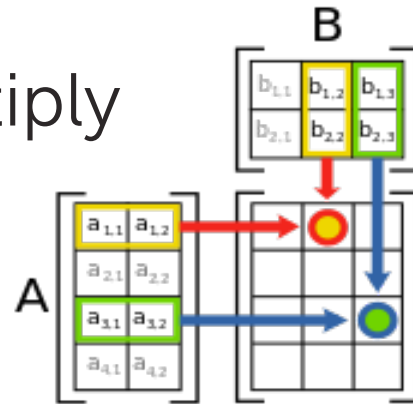
Concepts

- Loss functions, bias-variance tradeoff, cross-validation, sparsity, overfitting, model selection, feature selection

Assumed background

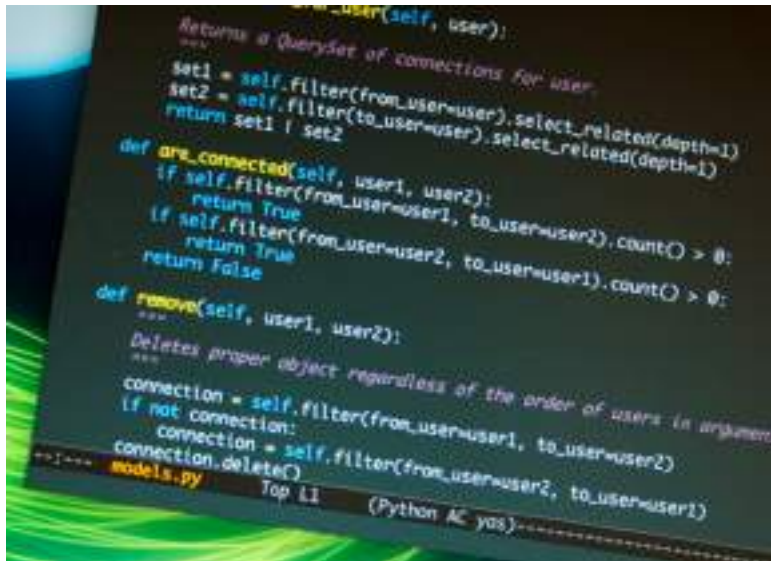
Math background

- Basic calculus
 - Concept of derivatives
- Basic linear algebra
 - Vectors
 - Matrices
 - Matrix multiply



Programming experience

- Basic Python used
 - Can pick up along the way if knowledge of other language



Reliance on GraphLab Create

- SFrames will be used, though not required
 - open source project of Dato (creators of GraphLab Create)
 - can use pandas and numpy instead
- Assignments will:
 1. Use GraphLab Create to explore high-level concepts
 2. Ask you to implement *all* algorithms without GraphLab Create
- Net result:
 - learn how to code methods in Python



Computing needs

- Basic 64-bit desktop or laptop
- Access to internet
- Ability to:
 - Install and run Python (and GraphLab Create)
 - Store a few GB of data





Let's get started!